Prehistoric plants

Word bank

mosses
Devonian
flowering
Jurassic
grassland
conifers
Permian

The earliest plants on Earth were marine algae that lived billions of years ago. During the Silurian period plants appeared on land. They were leafless **vascular** plants called psilophytes. Early mosses also appeared around the same time. The next plants to **evolve** were ferns and conifers, cycads and gingkoes. Many dinosaurs ate these species. Flowering plants and grasses are relatively modern in **geological** time. They developed during the Cretaceous period.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to fill in the table.

Time period	**Plant forms**
Tertiary	g_____ expands, forests shrink
Cretaceous	early f_____ plants, modern trees
J_____	cycads, conifers and gingkoes
Triassic	ferns, cycads, gingkoes and c_____
P_____	ferns and conifers
Carboniferous	club m_____, horsetails, ferns and cordaites
D_____	lowland forests of giant psilophyta plants

2 Match the pictures with the following statements.

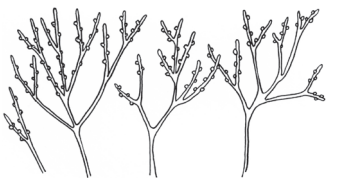
Psilophyta plants were common in the Devonian period.



Grasses grow today all over the world.



Flowering plants are very recent types of plants.



Ferns are a very ancient type of plant.



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